Practical 5: Build the RetailPulse Sales Prompt Report

Related topic: Design a Cognos Prompt Report for Sales Analysis

Objective

Design a prompt page with value, date-range, and cascading prompts, and link each control to a report filter.

Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access and the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab from Practical 4.

Step-by-step procedure

Step	Action in Cognos Analytics	What you should see
1	Open **RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab** from My content and switch to **Page explorer**.	The report has one page (the crosstab).
2	Click **Add page > Prompt page**; drag the new page above the crosstab page.	*Prompt Page 1* now precedes the crosstab page.
3	From the Toolbox drag a **Value prompt** (Region) and a **Date range prompt** (period) onto the prompt page.	Two controls appear; the wizard creates parameters pRegion and pPeriod.
4	Drag a second **Value prompt** (Store Name); in its properties set **Cascade source = pRegion**.	Store list shows only stores of the chosen region.
5	On the crosstab page add detail filters that reference each parameter (table below).	Each prompt control is linked to its filter.
6	Set defaults (Region = North, period = current quarter, Store = All stores), add a **Finish** button, then **Run** and test.	The report runs end to end; changing Region updates Store and the crosstab.

Prompt controls and linked filters

Prompt control	Type	Linked filter on the crosstab page	Parameter
Region	Value prompt (drop-down)	[Region] = ?pRegion?	pRegion
Reporting period	Date range prompt	[Sales Date] between ?pPeriod?	pPeriod
Store	Value prompt (list box), cascading	[Store Name] in ?pStore? (Cascade source: pRegion)	pStore

Sample solution

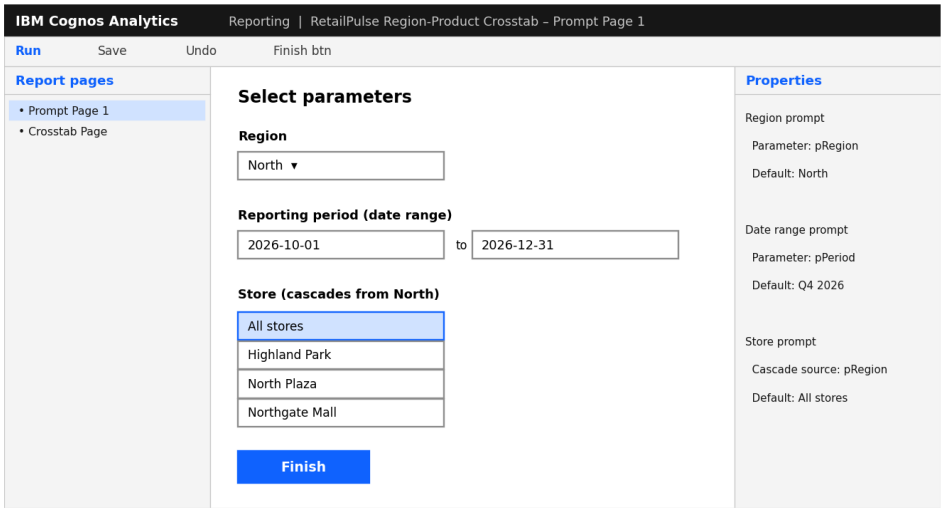


Figure 1. Prompt page design: Region = North, period = Q4 2026, Store list for North (default All stores).

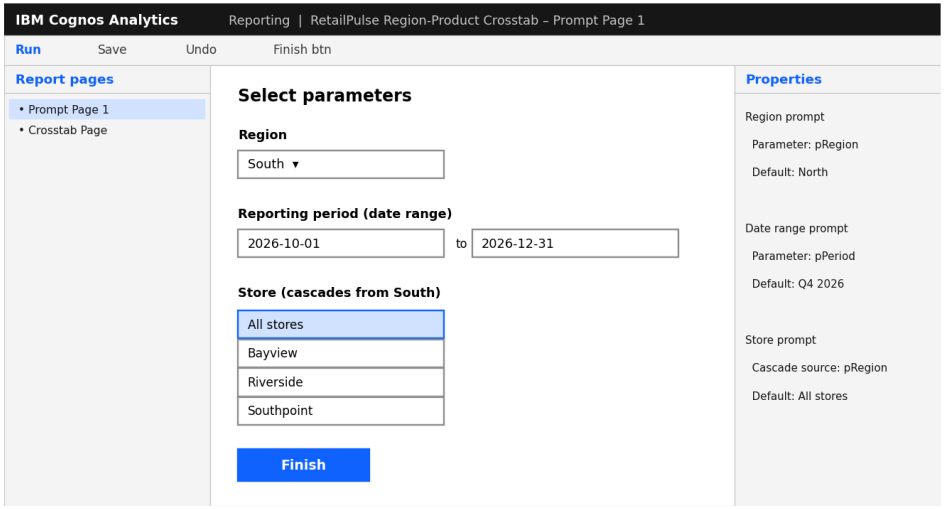


Figure 2. Region changed to South – the Store list updates to the South stores.

Run 1 – Region = North, 2026-10-01 to 2026-12-31, Store = All stores

	Apparel		Electronics		Grocery		Home & Kitchen		Sports & Outdoors		Total	
Region	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**
North	$17,971	378	$26,016	179	$14,954	1,074	$15,819	255	$14,952	207	$89,711	2,093
Total	**$17,971**	**378**	**$26,016**	**179**	**$14,954**	**1,074**	**$15,819**	**255**	**$14,952**	**207**	**$89,711**	**2,093**

Crosstab filtered to North: $89,711.15 and 2,093 units.

Run 2 – Region = South, 2026-10-01 to 2026-12-31, Store = All stores

	Apparel		Electronics		Grocery		Home & Kitchen		Sports & Outdoors		Total	
Region	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**
South	$22,565	468	$23,426	162	$17,443	1,247	$19,224	310	$17,859	249	$100,517	2,436
Total	**$22,565**	**468**	**$23,426**	**162**	**$17,443**	**1,247**	**$19,224**	**310**	**$17,859**	**249**	**$100,517**	**2,436**

Crosstab filtered to South: $100,517.23 and 2,436 units.

Run 3 – Region = North, Store = Northgate Mall (cascaded selection)

	Apparel		Electronics		Grocery		Home & Kitchen		Sports & Outdoors		Total	
Region	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**	**Sales Amount**	**Quantity**
North	$4,866	103	$7,038	48	$4,053	295	$4,274	70	$4,281	59	$24,511	575
Total	**$4,866**	**103**	**$7,038**	**48**	**$4,053**	**295**	**$4,274**	**70**	**$4,281**	**59**	**$24,511**	**575**

Crosstab filtered to one North store: $24,511.48 and 575 units.

Cascading test

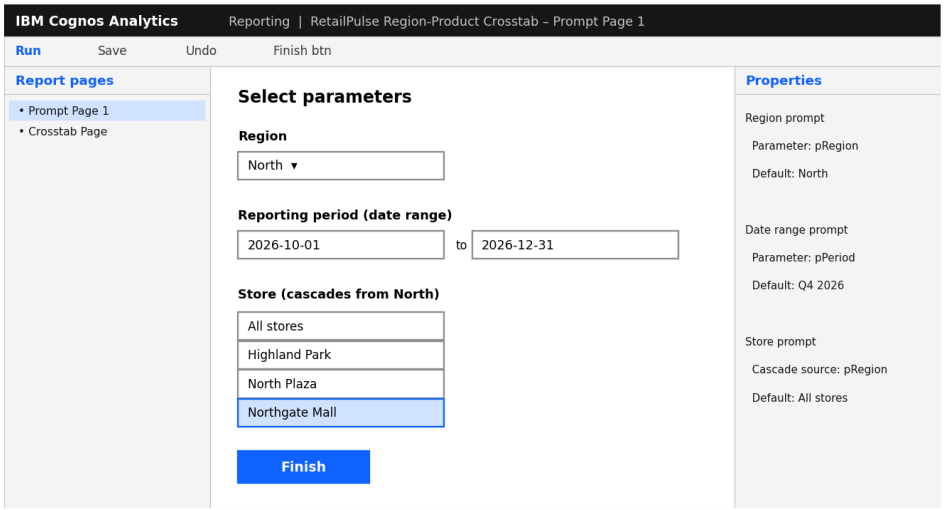


Figure 3. Store = Northgate Mall selected; the list contains only North stores.

Verification against the expected outcome

Expected outcome check	Result
Prompt page renders all three controls	**Pass** – Region, date range and Store prompts plus a Finish button
Changing Region updates the Store list without error	**Pass** – North stores replaced by South stores in Figure 2
Submitting returns a correctly filtered crosstab	**Pass** – Run 1 shows North only; Run 2 shows South only
Default values give a sensible report	**Pass** – Opening and clicking Finish returns North, Q4 2026, all stores
Filters are linked to the prompt controls	**Pass** – pRegion, pPeriod and pStore drive the three detail filters

Note on screens: the screenshots in this document are Cognos-style renderings produced from a synthetic RetailPulse dataset (12 stores, 4 regions, 5 product categories, 1 Jan–25 Oct 2026). Replace them with live captures from your own Cognos environment if your submission requires real screenshots.